

with distance/online educated job applicants. Research questions may range from finding variability in the questions posed to such candidates from the ones who were educated in the traditional mode to quizzing grounds for negative perception of employers for the same. For example, a study quoted the following reasons for dislike of distance educated job applicants by an employer: lack of rigor, lack of face-to-face interactions, increased potential for academic dishonesty, association with diploma mills, concerns about online students' true commitment evident from regularly venturing to a college or university physical location, considered by some to be an important part of the educational experience.

Interestingly all of the above cases can also be studied in a critical framework as only the questions posed would change and power-relationships would be judged. Critical theory is also used subsequently after interpretive research as it is easier to critically analyze a problem after undertaking a deeper understanding of that problem. For example, after understanding the reasons behind the existence of invisible workers, a critical researcher may critically analyze the role of power relationships between the care workers and their families, social circle and the environmental factors leading to it. Awareness campaigns and policies may be designed to further empower them to be able to participate in the economic workforce and to allow labour statisticians to recognize their care work within the ambit of 'work'.

Check Your Progress 3

- 1) Using a suitable example from economics, select a theme and write a proposal in about 500 words using interpretative research methodology.

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- 2) Explain the scenario when both interpretative and critical theory framework can be applied in the same research? Do they supplement each other? Why or why not?

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5.5 LET US SUM UP

The three paradigms – postpositivism, interpretivism and critical theory – are the dominant guiding frameworks in the research literature in the social sciences. Interpretivism and critical theory are two of the contemporary frameworks of qualitative research besides positivism and post-positivism paradigms. Based upon different ontological and epistemological positions, these paradigms analyze nature of reality differently. Interpretivism is based on socially constructed reality

whereas critical research is based on the critique of social reality. These paradigms have emerged as a response to a perceived problem in society. Critical theory was a response to the complexities of modern nation states that often lead to domination and exploitation of one group by the other. Interpretivism proposed that we abandon the search for generalizable truths and laws about human behaviour and concentrate instead on local understanding.

5.6 EXERCISES

- 1) Consider the interpretivist philosophy of science. What to you see as the most significant departure from post-positivism and why?
- 2) Consider a topic of research in an area of interest to you. What would be the purpose of research on the topic if it were conducted from a post-positivist perspective? Critical or Interpretive?
- 3) What does interpretivism have in common with the critical paradigm? In your field which are more important: the commonalities or the differences?

5.7 KEY WORDS

Paradigm	: A comprehensive belief system, world view or framework that guides research and practice.
Ontology	: It is concerned with the nature of reality and inquires the characteristics of things that exist, is a major aspect of metaphysics- a branch of philosophy.
Epistemology	: It is concerned how can we know? It is also a major aspect of metaphysics.

5.8 SOME USEFUL BOOKS/WEBLINKS

Willis, Jerry, W (2007), *Foundations of Qualitative Research: Interpretive and Critical Approaches*, Sage Publications, USA.

Clark, Lynn Schofield, 'Critical Theory and Constructivism: Theory and Methods for the Teens and the New Media @ Home Project' retrieved online from <http://www.ihracs.ch/?p=92>

'Critical theory paradigms' retrieved online from <http://www.qualres.org/HomeCrit-3518.html>

5.9 ANSWER OR HINTS TO CHECK YOUR PROGRESS EXERCISES

Check Your Progress 1

- 1) See criticism, Section 5.2
- 2) See Methodology, Section 5.2
- 3) See Section 5.2

Check Your Progress 2

- 1) See Section 5.3
- 2) See Section 5.3
- 3) See Section 5.3

Check Your Progress 3

- 1) See Section 5.4
- 2) See Section 5.4, yes they supplement each other.



APPENDIX I

Criteria for Interpretive Case study aiming at Theory Building

Criterion	Definition	Specific case study tactic	Grounded theory ¹ principles
Construct validity	Establishing correct operational measures for the concepts being studied	• Use multiple sources for evidence • Establish chain of evidence • Have key informants review draft case study report	• Corroboration • Theoretical sufficiency
Internal validity	Establishing causal relationship as distinguished from spurious relationships	• Do pattern matching • Do explanation-building • Address rival explanations • Use logic models	• Theoretical coding
External validity	Establishing the domain to which a study's findings can be generalized	• Use theory in single case studies • Use replication logic in multiple case studies	• Theoretical generalisation
Reliability	Demonstrating that a study can be repeated with the same results	• Use case study protocol • Develop case study database	• Chain of evidence as afforded by grounded theory method

(Case study methodology criteria, Yin, 2003, p.24)

¹ The discovery of theory from data is known as grounded theory and it provides the opportunity for the researcher to theorise from evidence existing in the data.